



University Centre Abdelhafid Boussouf E-learning Centre



English – Level 2

– Lesson 01 – Types of Clauses

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Students Concerned- Semester 3

<i>Institute</i>	<i>Department</i>	<i>Year</i>	<i>Speciality</i>
Letters and Languages	• Foreign Languages	Licentiate 2	French
Science and Technology	• Mathematics and Computer Science • Technical Science	Licentiate 2	-MI -ST
Economic Science	• Economic Science • Commercial Science • Management Science	Licentiate 2	All specialties

Objectives of the Lesson

- To make you understand the overall basics of a clause.
- To help you recognize a clause when coming across one.
- To facilitate the task of distinguishing between different types of clauses.

1. What is a Clause?

A **clause** can simply be identified as a grammatical unit that is a part of a sentence. A clause must include both a **subject** and a **verb**; in other words, combining a verb and a subject (Subject + Verb) create a clause. Thus, every clause has at least **one subject** and **one verb**. Accordingly, when there is **No subject** or **verb** there is **No clause**.

2. Types of Clauses

Clauses come in **two** main types: **independent (main clause)** and **dependent (subordinate clause)**. Both share the property of **subject-verb combination**. When standing alone the first type can make sense alone the second cannot.

- a. **Independent or Main Clause:** conveys a complete thought. Independent clauses can stand alone as sentences and make complete sense without the need to be joined with other supporting grammatical entities.

Subject + Verb = Complete Thought

• **INDEPENDENT CLAUSE**

Example: I never miss my English class.

Subject Verb

- b. **Dependent or Subordinate Clause:** conveys an incomplete thought, and cannot stand alone as a full sentence. In order for a **dependent clause** to be complete and make total sense it must be connected to a **main clause** through the use of a **subordinating conjunction**.

Note: A subordinating conjunction is a word, used to connect two clauses together (such as: although, because, when...).

Subordinating Conjunction + Subject + Verb = Complete Thought

• DEPENDENT CLAUSE

Example: Because I love it.



Subordinating conjunction Subject Verb

Let's practice

Which of the following clauses are independent or subordinate (dependent) clauses?

1. I washed my car this morning because it was dirty.
Independent clause Subordinating conjunction Subordinate clause
2. My cousin who owns a store brought me a scarf.
3. My friend although she is shy loves to socials.
4. Since I am home alone I will order pizza.
5. Whenever he visits my uncle loves to play chess with me.
6. When it comes to science I love chemical reactions.

References

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